

Chaim's Big Dream



*A Story of Tzedakah,
Challenge, and Hilchos Ribbis*



As a young boy, Chaim had a big dream.
One day, he hoped to make a lot of money —
not just for himself, but to help others.
He dreamed of supporting Torah, helping people
in need, and doing great acts of chesed.
Chaim did not just dream. He worked hard.



When he grew older, Chaim started as an assistant in a real estate office. He worked hard, learned the business, and eventually became the manager. Later, he opened his own real estate investment company. Step by step, Chaim's big dream was beginning to come true.



Chaim's business did very well.
He bought properties, made investments,
and became involved in many businesses.
But as his success grew, his tzedakah grew too.
He supported yeshivos, kollelim, and chesed,
giving a full fifth of his income to tzedakah.



Then Chaim made the biggest investment of his life. He bought a beautiful, enormous resort for \$250 million and borrowed \$225 million to help pay for it. At first, everything went according to plan. Then one terrible day, a huge fire broke out and the entire resort was destroyed.



Chaim thought the insurance would cover the loss.

But the payment had gone to the wrong address, and the policy had been canceled.

Then Chaim remembered that many of his other properties had been used as collateral for the loan.

He turned pale as he realized that he could lose everything.



For three years, Chaim fought to save his businesses and properties. He met with lawyers, bankers, and investors, looking for every possible solution. But in the end, the bank took the assets he had promised as collateral.

After all those years of success, Chaim was left with almost nothing but his home.



A Rosh Kollel came to ask Chaim for support, not knowing what had happened.

With pain, Chaim cried that after giving so much tzedakah, he had been left with almost nothing.

Rav Steinman explained that Chaim needed to strengthen himself in Hilchos Ribbis.

Chaim accepted this message, and he began learning Hilchos Ribbis and helping others learn it too.